
Love at Work

When attraction meets the professional

4 psychology approaches · tips — by EvaTalk

TO BEGIN

When attraction meets the professional

Work is one of the places where the most couples form — but it's also risky ground: career, reputation, awkwardness if it goes wrong. And a non-negotiable principle: never a power dynamic.

This guide helps you navigate a workplace attraction with clarity, respect and professionalism.

YOUR INTENTION

Your situation, and what worries you most about it: _____

The specific risks

A relationship at work involves more than your heart: your career, reputation, team atmosphere, and the delicate 'after' if it ends. The hierarchy changes everything: pursuing someone you have power over (or vice versa) is off-limits.

Understanding these stakes saves you serious mistakes.

Example

Léa realized attraction to a colleague she'd manage posed a real power problem — and knew to abstain.

The stakes

What concrete risks (career, team) does this situation carry?

Never power

Write: 'No attraction to act on if there's a power dynamic.'

Takeaway — Never a relationship when a power dynamic exists.

Over-analyzing signals

'That look meant something', 'are they flirting or not?': at work you over-interpret fast, risking serious mistakes and awkwardness.

Reframe: only clear, mutual, explicit interest counts — the rest is fantasy.

Example

'They're definitely interested' carried Sami away, until he understood at work certainty beats supposition.

Spot over-analysis

Note a hasty interpretation · a more careful reading.

Clear, not vague

Write: 'At work, only clear, mutual interest counts.'

Takeaway — At work, act only on clear, mutual interest.

Absolute respect for the no

Respect comes before desire: never pressure, persistent advances, or making a colleague uncomfortable. A 'no' (or even vagueness) is respected immediately and fully.

Preserving the other's comfort and dignity comes before your wish.

Example

Sensing her colleague wasn't comfortable, Nia immediately stopped all advances — out of respect.

The other's comfort

How to ensure the other is fully comfortable and free?

The no first

Write: 'A no, or vagueness, is respected immediately.'

Takeaway — The other's respect and comfort come before your desire.

The rules to keep it healthy

In practice: no hierarchy, discretion, knowing your company's rules, a clean pro/personal separation, and a clear agreement on 'what if it ends?'. If any doubt remains about free consent, abstain.

A clear frame protects your career, the other person, and the team.

Example

By setting rules of discretion and professionalism, Karim and his partner protected their couple AND their work.

My rules

Your 2-3 rules to keep it healthy and professional: _____

The 'if it ends'

Write: 'We anticipate, calmly, what we do if it ends.'

Takeaway — No hierarchy, discretion, known rules, a plan for the after.

Key takeaways

- Never a relationship when a power dynamic exists.
- A work relationship involves career, reputation, team.
- Act only on clear, mutual interest — not a supposition.
- Respect a no (or vagueness) immediately and fully.
- Discretion, professionalism, company rules.
- Anticipate, calmly, 'what if it ends?'.

Your turn

The stakes

The concrete risks	The interpretation to check

My frame

The other's comfort	My rules / the 'if it ends'

YOUR JOURNEY

Your 4-week plan

Week 1

Weigh the risks and exclude any power dynamic.

Week 2

Stop over-analyzing, aim for clarity.

Week 3

Guarantee the other's respect and comfort.

Week 4

Set healthy rules and a plan for the after.

YOUR PLAN

Your action plan

My 'never a power dynamic' rule:

The concrete risk I weigh:

My pro/personal rules:

At work, respect and clarity come before attraction.

This guide is a coaching and psychoeducation tool — not therapy. It's for everyone, whatever your gender or orientation. Respect and consent come first: if a date endangers or disrespects you, your safety comes first. © PerfectMatch · EvaTalk.